SSC CGL 2026

GENERAL AWARENESS – ASKED QUESTIONS

Reported Questions with Explanations

Tier-1 (30 Sep – Oct 2026, new pattern) • Static GS only • Chapter-wise

History • Art & Culture • Polity • Geography • Economy • Science • Static GK – questions reported by candidates from SSC CGL 2026 Tier-1 shifts, compiled from coaching-site analyses, each with a full explanation

Memory-based (candidate-recalled) questions, not an official SSC paper. Verify answers with the official SSC answer key when released. Explanations are original.

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INTRODUCTION

Read This First – 2026 Pattern, Sources and Trends

0.1 Which 2026 Exams Are Covered

As of 30 October 2026, the only SSC exam on the new pattern that has been held with GS questions reported is the Combined Graduate Level (CGL) 2026 Tier-1. Its CBT window was 30 September – late October 2026 (coaching sites give 28 or 30 October as the last date). Per the revised calendar reported by coaching sites, the other exams had not yet been held:

Exam	Status (as reported by coaching sites, Oct 2026)
CGL 2026 Tier-1	Held: 30 Sep – end Oct 2026 (covered in this book)
JE 2026 Paper-I	Scheduled 2–6 Nov 2026
CPO 2026 Paper-I	Scheduled 20–28 Nov 2026
CHSL 2026 Tier-1	Scheduled 30 Nov – 31 Dec 2026
GD Constable	Early 2027

✖ **COMMON MISTAKE:** Calendars published by different coaching sites disagree. Confirm every date on ssc.gov.in.

0.2 CGL 2026 Tier-1 – New Pattern

Section	Questions	Marks	Sectional time
General Intelligence & Reasoning	25	50	15 min
General Awareness	25	50	15 min
Quantitative Aptitude	25	50	15 min
English Comprehension	25	50	15 min
Total	100	200	60 min

- New in 2026: each section has its own 15-minute timer. Time left over in GA cannot be carried to another section, so GA must be finished (or abandoned) within 15 minutes.
- Negative marking: 0.50 for each wrong answer (2 marks per correct answer).
- Reported good attempts in GA: about 15–20 out of 25 across shifts; GA was rated Moderate in most shifts (Easy–Moderate in a few).

0.3 What the 2026 GA Section Looked Like (Shift Analyses)

Coaching-site analyses of 2026 shifts give this approximate break-up of the 25 GA questions:

Area	Questions per shift (approx.)
General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology)	5–7
Static GK (dances, festivals, books, sports, awards)	5–7

Area	Questions per shift (approx.)
Current Affairs	3–5
Polity	2–3 (constitutional articles and amendments ≈ 3–4 in some shifts)
History	2–3
Geography	1–3
Economics	1–2
Miscellaneous	1–2

- Main message: about 80% of the 2026 GA section was static GS. Current affairs was only 3–5 questions per shift.
- Recurring themes across reported shifts: constitutional Articles (1, 32, 131A, 243, 312, 360) and amendments; 1991 reforms and Five-Year Plans; BNS/BNSS; folk dances and festivals of the North-East and Odisha; musicians and instruments; books and authors; sports firsts and terms.

0.4 How This Book Was Compiled (Please Read)

- Sources: memory-based papers and shift analyses published by Prepp, Examshortcut, Physics Wallah (PW), Career Power, Adda247, Testbook and Notifyhere (full list in the last chapter). These sites were consulted through web search summaries; their full PDFs could not be opened from this environment.
- These are questions recalled by candidates, not the official SSC paper. Wording below is a reconstruction of the reported question, not the exact SSC text, and options are not reproduced.
- Each question carries a tag: exam · date · shift · source. Where a source gave no shift, the tag says so.
- Answers marked "(verified)" are standard facts I checked against my own knowledge. Where a source flagged doubt, this is noted.
- Every explanation and every "revise next" list is original, written to help you answer any variation of the same question.
- Coverage is partial: many shifts' GA questions had not been published at the time of compiling ("to be updated" on the sites). This book will grow when the full shift-wise papers become available.
- Current-affairs questions are excluded as you asked; they are listed by name only in the second-last chapter.

✔ **TOPPER TRICK:** Use each reported question as a doorway into its topic. The question itself will not repeat word-for-word, but its neighbourhood (the same Article group, the same dance region, the same musician list) gets asked again in later shifts and later exams.

CHAPTER 1

Polity – Reported Questions & Explanations

1.1 Article 1 – Union and its Territory

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** What does Article 1 of the Constitution say about India? [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic list]

✔ **ANSWER:** Article 1(1): 'India, that is Bharat, shall be a Union of States.' (verified)

Explanation. Article 1 opens Part I (Articles 1–4, 'The Union and its Territory'). The Constitution calls India a 'Union of States', not a 'Federation of States'. Dr. Ambedkar explained the choice in the Constituent Assembly: the Indian federation is not the result of an agreement among states (unlike the USA), and no state has the right to secede. Article 1(2) says the states and territories are specified in the First Schedule. Article 1(3) says the territory of India comprises the territories of the states, the Union Territories, and any territories that may be acquired.

Art 1 – Union of States (no right to secede) | Art 2 – admit/establish new states (from outside India) | Art 3 – form new states, alter areas/boundaries/names (simple majority; President's recommendation) | Art 4 – Art 2 & 3 laws are not Art 368 amendments

- 'Territory of India' (states + UTs + acquired) is wider than 'Union of India' (states only).
- Article 3 bills: introduced only on the President's recommendation; the President refers the bill to the affected state legislature, but its views are not binding on Parliament.

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Article 1 wording; difference between Article 2 and Article 3; First Schedule lists states and UTs; Ambedkar's reason for 'Union'.

1.2 Article 32 – Right to Constitutional Remedies

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Which Article gives the right to move the Supreme Court for enforcement of Fundamental Rights? [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW] and a question on Article 32 / Supreme Court writs [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper]

✔ **ANSWER:** Article 32 (verified). Ambedkar called it the 'heart and soul of the Constitution'.

Explanation. Article 32 is itself a Fundamental Right in Part III. It lets any person whose Fundamental Right is violated approach the Supreme Court directly. The SC can issue five writs: Habeas Corpus, Mandamus, Prohibition, Certiorari and Quo Warranto. High Courts issue writs under Article 226, which is wider because it covers Fundamental Rights and 'any other purpose' (legal rights). Parliament can empower other courts to issue writs (Art 32(3)). The right under Art 32 cannot be suspended except as provided by the Constitution (during a national emergency, by Presidential order under Art 359 – but Articles 20 and 21 can never be suspended after the 44th Amendment).

Writ	Meaning	Use
Habeas Corpus	'To have the body'	Against illegal detention; can be issued against private persons too
Mandamus	'We command'	Directs a public official/body to perform a public duty; not against the President, Governors or private persons
Prohibition	'To forbid'	Higher court stops a lower court/tribunal from exceeding jurisdiction (during proceedings)
Certiorari	'To be certified'	Higher court quashes the order of a lower court/tribunal (after decision); since 1991 also against administrative bodies affecting rights
Quo Warranto	'By what authority'	Against a person illegally holding a public office

Art 32 – SC writs ('heart and soul') | Art 226 – HC writs (wider scope) | Art 359 – suspension in emergency (not Art 20, 21)

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Revise Articles 12–35 group-wise; writ meanings; difference between Art 32 and Art 226; 'heart and soul' quote.

1.3 Article 131A (Omitted Article)

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Questions on Article 131A were reported (several items on Articles 243 and 131A in one shift). [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

✔ **ANSWER:** Article 131A was inserted by the 42nd Amendment (1976) to give the Supreme Court exclusive jurisdiction over questions of the constitutional validity of central laws. It was omitted by the 43rd Amendment (1977). (verified)

Explanation. During the Emergency, the 42nd Amendment tried to restrict High Courts' power of judicial review over central laws by inserting Article 131A (exclusive SC jurisdiction for validity of central laws), Article 144A (minimum number of judges to decide such questions) and Article 226A (HCs barred from deciding validity of central laws). The Janata government's 43rd Amendment (1977) repealed all three and restored the courts' powers; the 44th Amendment (1978) undid other Emergency-era changes.

- Article 131 (still in force): original jurisdiction of the Supreme Court in disputes between the Centre and states, or between states. Private persons cannot file a suit under Art 131.

Art 131 – SC original jurisdiction (Centre–state disputes) | Art 131A – inserted 42nd (1976), omitted 43rd (1977) | Art 143 – advisory jurisdiction | Art 141 – SC law binding on all courts

★ **REVISE NEXT:** SC jurisdictions – original (131), writ (32), appellate (132–134), advisory (143), court of record (129), review (137), complete justice (142). What the 42nd, 43rd and 44th Amendments did.

✖ **COMMON MISTAKE:** 'Omitted' Articles still get asked. 131A, 144A and 226A were all removed by the 43rd Amendment.

1.4 Article 243 – Panchayats

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Questions on Article 243 (Panchayati Raj) were reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

✔ **ANSWER:** Article 243 contains definitions for Part IX (The Panchayats), inserted by the 73rd Amendment, 1992. (verified)

Explanation. The 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992 (in force 24 April 1993 – National Panchayati Raj Day) added Part IX (Articles 243 to 243-O) and the Eleventh Schedule (29 subjects). Article 243 defines terms such as 'district', 'Gram Sabha', 'intermediate level', 'Panchayat', 'Panchayat area' and 'village'.

Article	Provision
243	Definitions
243A	Gram Sabha
243B	Constitution of Panchayats – three tiers (village, intermediate, district); intermediate tier not compulsory if state population < 20 lakh
243C	Composition; direct elections
243D	Reservation – SCs/STs in proportion to population; not less than one-third seats (and chairpersons) for women
243E	Five-year term; fresh elections within six months of dissolution
243F	Disqualifications
243G	Powers – 29 subjects of the Eleventh Schedule
243H	Taxes and funds
243I	State Finance Commission every five years
243K	State Election Commission
243M	Not applicable to certain areas (Nagaland, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Sixth Schedule areas, hill areas of Manipur, Darjeeling)
243-O	Bar to interference by courts in electoral matters

- Municipalities: 74th Amendment, Part IX-A (Articles 243P–243ZG), Twelfth Schedule (18 subjects). Co-operatives: 97th Amendment, Part IX-B (Articles 243ZH–243ZT).
- History: Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (1957) recommended three tiers; first implemented at Nagaur, Rajasthan, on 2 October 1959. Ashok Mehta Committee (1977) – two tiers. L.M. Singhvi Committee (1986) – constitutional status. Article 40 (DPSP) asks the state to organise village panchayats.

73rd (1992) – Part IX, Art 243–243-O, 11th Schedule (29) | 74th – Part IX-A, 12th Schedule (18) | Women ≥ 1/3 | Term 5 years | First PRI – Nagaur 1959

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Article number for Gram Sabha (243A), State Election Commission (243K), State Finance Commission (243I); number of Eleventh-Schedule subjects; Balwant Rai Mehta; Article 40.

1.5 97th Amendment – Co-operative Societies

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** A question on the 97th Constitutional Amendment was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

✔ **ANSWER:** The 97th Amendment (2011, in force February 2012) gave constitutional status to co-operative societies. (verified)

Explanation. It made three changes: (1) added 'co-operative societies' to Article 19(1)(c) – right to form associations, unions and co-operative societies (a Fundamental Right); (2) inserted Article 43B in DPSP – the state shall promote voluntary formation, autonomous functioning, democratic control and professional management of co-operatives; (3) added Part IX-B (Articles 243ZH–243ZT). In 2021 (Union of India v. Rajendra N. Shah) the Supreme Court struck down Part IX-B in so far as it applies to state co-operatives (it lacked ratification by half the states); it remains valid for multi-state co-operatives. Ministry of Co-operation created in 2021.

97th (2011) – Art 19(1)(c) co-operatives, Art 43B, Part IX-B | Part IX-B partly struck down 2021 (Rajendra Shah case)

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Revise the important amendments table – 1st, 7th, 24th, 42nd, 44th, 52nd, 61st, 73rd, 74th, 86th, 91st, 97th, 101st, 103rd, 104th, 106th.

1.6 Article 312 – All India Services

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Which Article lets the Rajya Sabha initiate the creation of new All India Services? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper]

✔ **ANSWER:** Article 312 (verified).

Explanation. Under Article 312, if the Rajya Sabha passes a resolution supported by two-thirds of members present and voting, declaring it necessary in the national interest, Parliament may by law create new All India Services (common to the Union and states), including an All India Judicial Service. Existing AIS: IAS and IPS (deemed created by the Constitution), Indian Forest Service (1966). This is one of the special powers of the Rajya Sabha; the other is Article 249 (resolution to let Parliament legislate on a State List subject in the national interest). Sardar Patel is called the 'father of All India Services' (the 'steel frame').

Art 312 – new AIS by RS 2/3 resolution | Art 249 – RS resolution for State List | Existing AIS – IAS, IPS, IFoS (1966) | Patel – father of AIS

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Special powers of Rajya Sabha (249, 312); exclusive powers of Lok Sabha (money bill, no-confidence motion); UPSC (Art 315–323).

1.7 Article 360 – Financial Emergency and the Governor's Discretion

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Topics reported: Financial Emergency (Article 360) and the Governor's discretionary powers. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic list]

✔ **ANSWER:** Article 360 – financial emergency, declared by the President when the financial stability or credit of India is threatened; it has never been declared. (verified)

Explanation. A financial emergency must be approved by both Houses within two months (simple majority) and then continues indefinitely until revoked. During it, the Centre can direct states to observe financial propriety, reduce salaries of state employees, and require money

bills of states to be reserved for the President; salaries of Union employees and SC/HC judges can be reduced.

Emergency	Article	Approval	Used?
National	352 (war, external aggression, armed rebellion)	Within 1 month, special majority; renew every 6 months	1962, 1971, 1975
State (President's Rule)	356 (failure of constitutional machinery); 365	Within 2 months, simple majority; max 3 years	Many times; first Punjab 1951
Financial	360	Within 2 months, simple majority; no maximum	Never

- Governor's discretionary powers (Art 163): reserving a bill for the President (Art 200); recommending President's Rule (Art 356); appointing the Chief Minister when no party has a clear majority; dismissing a ministry that has lost confidence; additional charge as administrator of a UT; seeking information from the CM (Art 167). The Governor's satisfaction on what is discretionary is final (Art 163(2)), but the Supreme Court (Nabam Rebia 2016, S.R. Bommai 1994) has limited arbitrary use.

Art 352 national (used 3 times) | Art 356 President's Rule | Art 360 financial (never used) | Art 163 Governor's discretion | Art 200 reserve bill

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Emergency Articles and their approval periods; grounds of national emergency (44th Amendment replaced 'internal disturbance' with 'armed rebellion'); Governor's discretionary powers; Sarkaria and Punchhi Commissions on Centre–state relations.

1.8 BNS / BNSS and Zero FIR

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** A question on Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita / Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita and 'zero FIR' was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

✔ **ANSWER:** Under the BNSS (2023, in force 1 July 2024), Section 173 provides for a zero FIR – information about a cognisable offence can be registered at any police station, irrespective of where the offence happened, and then transferred to the police station with jurisdiction. (verified)

Explanation. Three new criminal laws came into force on 1 July 2024: Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) replaced the Indian Penal Code, 1860; Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) replaced the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973; Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA) replaced the Indian Evidence Act, 1872. Key features: e-FIR and zero FIR given statutory backing; mandatory videography of search and seizure; forensic investigation compulsory for offences punishable with seven years or more; community service as a punishment for petty offences; 'mob lynching' and 'organised crime' and 'terrorist act' defined; sedition (old Sec 124A) dropped and replaced by an offence against acts endangering sovereignty, unity and integrity of India (Sec 152 BNS); trials in absentia for proclaimed offenders; electronic records admissible as primary evidence (BSA).

- The concept of zero FIR existed earlier through Justice J.S. Verma Committee recommendations (after 2012) and court rulings; the BNSS gave it statutory form.

1 July 2024 – BNS (IPC), BNSS (CrPC), BSA (Evidence Act) | Zero FIR – BNSS Sec 173 | Sedition removed; Sec 152 BNS

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Which law replaced which; date of enforcement; zero FIR and e-FIR; community service; offences newly defined.

1.9 Polity – Revise Next (Pattern From 2026 Shifts)

- Every reported shift had Article-number questions. Make a 2-column list: Article → subject, for at least Articles 1–4, 12–35, 36–51A, 52–78, 79–122, 123, 124–147, 148, 153–167, 213, 214–231, 243 series, 249, 262–263, 266–267, 275, 280, 300A, 312, 315–323, 324–329, 330–342, 343–351, 352–360, 368.
- Amendments: about 3–4 questions per shift came from the Constitution's Articles and amendments, according to one 2026 analysis. Revise the amendments table in the GS notes book (Chapter 6).

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Articles with numbers, amendments with years, Supreme Court jurisdiction, emergency provisions, Panchayati Raj, new criminal laws (BNS/BNSS/BSA).

CHAPTER 2

History – Reported Questions & Explanations

2.1 Founder of the Mauryan Empire

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Who founded the Mauryan Empire? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper]

✔ **ANSWER:** Chandragupta Maurya (c. 321 BCE), with the guidance of Chanakya (Kautilya). (verified)

Explanation. Chandragupta overthrew the last Nanda king, Dhanananda, and established his capital at Pataliputra (near modern Patna). He defeated Seleucus Nikator (305 BCE); the treaty gave him Arachosia, Gedrosia and Paropamisadae, and Seleucus sent Megasthenes as ambassador, who wrote 'Indica'. Late in life Chandragupta adopted Jainism under Bhadrabahu and died at Shravanabelagola (Karnataka) by sallekhana. His successors: Bindusara ('Amitraghata') and Ashoka (Kalinga war 261 BCE). The last Mauryan ruler, Brihadratha, was killed by his general Pushyamitra Shunga (185 BCE).

Chandragupta Maurya – founder (321 BCE) | Chanakya – Arthashastra | Megasthenes – Indica | Seleucus defeated 305 BCE | Died at Shravanabelagola

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Revise founders of dynasties: Haryanka – Bimbisara, Nanda – Mahapadma Nanda, Shunga – Pushyamitra, Kanva – Vasudeva, Satavahana – Simuka, Gupta – Sri Gupta (Chandragupta I real founder), Pushyabhuti – Pushyabhuti (Harsha), Pallava – Simhavishnu, Chalukya (Badami) – Pulakeshin I, Rashtrakuta – Dantidurga, Pala – Gopala, Chola (imperial) – Vijayalaya, Slave dynasty – Qutbuddin Aibak, Vijayanagara – Harihara & Bukka, Bahmani – Hasan Gangu, Mughal – Babur.

2.2 The 18 Puranas

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** A question on the number of Puranas (18) was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

✔ **ANSWER:** There are 18 Mahapuranas. (verified)

Explanation. The Puranas are Sanskrit texts of the post-Vedic period, compiled mostly in the Gupta age, traditionally attributed to Vyasa. They describe creation (sarga), re-creation (pratisarga), genealogy of gods and sages (vamsha), the ages of Manu (manvantara) and dynasties of kings (vamshanucharita) – these five are called 'Pancha Lakshana'. The 18 Mahapuranas include Vishnu, Bhagavata, Shiva, Vayu, Matsya, Markandeya, Brahma, Brahmanda, Padma, Agni, Garuda, Kurma, Linga, Narada, Skanda, Vamana, Varaha and Bhavishya Purana. The Matsya Purana is regarded as the oldest; the Vayu, Vishnu and Matsya Puranas give dynastic lists of the Mauryas, Satavahanas and Guptas – useful historical sources. There are also 18 Upapuranas.

Number to remember	Text
4	Vedas
6	Vedangas; schools of philosophy (Darshanas)
18	Mahapuranas; chapters (parvas) of the Mahabharata; chapters of the Bhagavad Gita
108	Upanishads (traditional count)
1028	Hymns in the Rigveda (10 mandalas)
24,000	Verses in the Ramayana (7 kandas)
1,00,000	Verses in the Mahabharata ('Shatasahasri Samhita')

18 Mahapuranas | Matsya Purana oldest | Pancha Lakshana – 5 topics | Mahabharata – 18 parvas, 1 lakh verses | Ramayana – 7 kandas, 24,000 verses

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Number-based questions on ancient texts; Upanishad source of 'Satyameva Jayate' (Mundaka); Samaveda and music; Gita's 18 chapters.

2.3 Fatawa-e-Alamgiri

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** In which year/whose reign was the Fatawa-e-Alamgiri compiled? [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

✔ **ANSWER:** Under Aurangzeb (Alamgir), compiled roughly between 1664 and 1672. (verified; exact years vary slightly by source)

Explanation. The Fatawa-e-Alamgiri (also Fatawa-i-Hindiyya) is a compilation of Islamic law based on the Hanafi school, prepared by a board of jurists led by Sheikh Nizamuddin Burhanpuri on Aurangzeb's orders. It became the basis of law in the Mughal Empire and was later used by British courts for Muslim personal law. Other Aurangzeb facts: re-imposed jizya (1679); banned music at court (but he played the veena himself, per tradition); executed Guru Tegh Bahadur (1675); built Moti Masjid in the Red Fort, Delhi, and the Badshahi Mosque, Lahore; Bibi ka Maqbara (Aurangabad) was built by his son Azam Shah for his mother Dilras Banu Begum; 'Zinda Pir'; died at Ahmednagar (1707); buried at Khuldabad.

Mughal-era text	Author
Baburnama (Tuzuk-i-Baburi)	Babur (Turkish)
Humayunnama	Gulbadan Begum
Akbarnama, Ain-i-Akbari	Abul Fazl
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	Jahangir
Padshahnama	Abdul Hamid Lahori (Shah Jahan)
Majma-ul-Bahrain, Sirr-i-Akbar (Upanishads in Persian)	Dara Shikoh
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	Abdul Qadir Badauni
Tabaqat-i-Akbari	Nizamuddin Ahmad
Fatawa-e-Alamgiri	Board of jurists under Aurangzeb
Muntakhab-ul-Lubab	Khafi Khan (Aurangzeb's reign)

Fatawa-e-Alamgiri – Aurangzeb (c. 1664–72), Hanafi law | Jizya re-imposed 1679 | Dara Shikoh – Majma-ul-Bahrain

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Mughal books and authors; Aurangzeb's policies; Dara Shikoh's translations; Bibi ka Maqbara.

2.4 Taj Mahal

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** A question on the Taj Mahal (timeline and patron) was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic list]

✔ **ANSWER:** Built by Shah Jahan in memory of Mumtaz Mahal (Arjumand Banu Begum); construction c. 1632–1653; chief architect Ustad Ahmad Lahori; UNESCO World Heritage Site since 1983. (verified)

Explanation. The Taj stands on the right bank of the Yamuna at Agra. It is built of white Makrana marble (Rajasthan) with pietra dura inlay (parchin kari), set in a charbagh garden. It was declared one of the New Seven Wonders of the World (2007). Air pollution (SO_2 from the Mathura refinery and other sources) causes 'marble cancer' – yellowing – and the Taj Trapezium Zone was created to protect it. Other Shah Jahan buildings: Red Fort (Delhi), Jama Masjid (Delhi), Moti Masjid (Agra Fort), Shalimar Bagh (Lahore), Peacock Throne (Takht-e-Taus, taken by Nadir Shah in 1739).

Taj Mahal – Shah Jahan, for Mumtaz Mahal | 1632–1653 | Ustad Ahmad Lahori | Makrana marble | UNESCO 1983

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Mughal monuments and builders – Humayun's Tomb (Hamida Banu Begum; first garden tomb), Buland Darwaza and Fatehpur Sikri (Akbar), Itmad-ud-Daulah's tomb (Nur Jahan; first use of pietra dura), Akbar's tomb at Sikandra (Jahangir), Red Fort & Jama Masjid (Shah Jahan), Bibi ka Maqbara (Azam Shah).

2.5 Abolition of Sati

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** A question on the abolition of the practice of Sati was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic list]

✔ **ANSWER:** Sati was abolished by Bengal Regulation XVII of 1829 under Governor-General Lord William Bentinck, with the support of Raja Ram Mohan Roy. (verified)

Explanation. Ram Mohan Roy campaigned against sati through his writings and petitions (his sister-in-law had been forced into it). The regulation of 4 December 1829 applied first to the Bengal Presidency and was extended to Madras and Bombay in 1830. Orthodox groups (Dharma Sabha of Radhakanta Deb) appealed to the Privy Council, which upheld the ban in 1832. Akbar and the Peshwas had earlier tried to discourage sati. After independence, the Commission of Sati (Prevention) Act, 1987 was passed after the Roop Kanwar case (Deorala, Rajasthan).

Social reform law	Year	Governor-General / person
Abolition of Sati	1829	William Bentinck (Ram Mohan Roy)
Female infanticide prohibition	1795, 1804 (Bengal Regulations)	–
Abolition of slavery	1843	Ellenborough
Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act	1856	Canning (Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar)

Social reform law	Year	Governor-General / person
Native Marriage Act (civil marriage)	1872	Northbrook (Keshab Chandra Sen)
Age of Consent Act	1891	Lansdowne (Behramji Malabari)
Sarda Act (Child Marriage Restraint)	1929	Irwin (Harbilas Sarda)

Sati abolished – Regulation XVII, 4 Dec 1829, Bentinck + Ram Mohan Roy | Widow Remarriage – 1856 | Sarda Act – 1929

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Social reform laws with Governors-General; Brahmo Samaj (1828); Vidyasagar; Sarda Act age limits (girls 14, boys 18 originally).

2.6 Kailasanatha Temple

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Which dynasty built the Kailasanatha temple? [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper – reported, not confirmed by other sources]

✔ **ANSWER:** Kailasanatha temple, Kanchipuram – Pallava dynasty, built by Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha), c. 700 CE; completed by his son Mahendravarman III. (verified)

Explanation. It is the oldest structural temple in Kanchipuram and an early example of Dravidian architecture in stone (rather than rock-cut). Do not confuse it with the Kailasa (Kailasanatha) temple, Cave 16, Ellora (Maharashtra), a monolithic rock-cut temple built by the Rashtrakuta king Krishna I (8th century). In the exam, read the place carefully: Kanchipuram → Pallava; Ellora → Rashtrakuta.

Temple	Dynasty / builder
Shore Temple, Mahabalipuram	Pallava – Narasimhavarman II
Pancha Rathas, Mahabalipuram	Pallava – Narasimhavarman I (Mamalla)
Kailasanatha, Kanchipuram	Pallava – Narasimhavarman II
Kailasa, Ellora	Rashtrakuta – Krishna I
Virupaksha, Pattadakal	Chalukya (Badami) – Queen Lokamahadevi
Brihadeshwara, Thanjavur	Chola – Rajaraja I
Gangaikonda Cholapuram	Chola – Rajendra I
Airavatesvara, Darasuram	Chola – Rajaraja II
Hoysaleswara, Halebidu; Chennakesava, Belur	Hoysala (Vishnuvardhana – Belur)
Sun Temple, Konark	Eastern Ganga – Narasimhadeva I
Jagannath, Puri	Eastern Ganga – Anantavarman Chodaganga
Lingaraja, Bhubaneswar	Somavamshi/Ganga
Kandariya Mahadeva, Khajuraho	Chandela – Vidyadhara
Dilwara temples, Mount Abu	Solanki ministers Vimal Shah, Vastupal–Tejpal
Sun Temple, Modhera	Solanki – Bhima I
Ramappa, Palampet	Kakatiya – Recharla Rudra (Ganapati Deva's general)
Meenakshi, Madurai	Pandya origins; rebuilt by Nayakas
Vitthala, Hampi	Vijayanagara – Krishnadeva Raya era

Kailasanatha, Kanchipuram – Pallava (Narasimhavarman II) | Kailasa, Ellora – Rashtrakuta (Krishna I) | Shore Temple – Pallava | Konark – Eastern Ganga

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Temple–dynasty pairs; Nagara/Dravida/Vesara styles; UNESCO temples (Great Living Chola Temples, Hoysala temples 2023, Ramappa 2021).

✖ **COMMON MISTAKE:** Two temples share the name 'Kailasa/Kailasanatha'. Questions that name only 'Kailasanatha temple' usually mean Kanchipuram; check the place in the question.

2.7 Stupa – the Umbrella Structure

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** What is the umbrella-like structure on top of a stupa called? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper; the source's own answer pairing was unclear]

✔ **ANSWER:** Chhatra (chhatravali for the tiered parasols). (verified; 'Harmika' is the square railed platform on top of the dome, below the chhatra)

Explanation. Parts of a stupa from the bottom: medhi (circular drum/base), anda (hemispherical dome – the cosmic mountain; contains the relics), harmika (square railing on top of the anda – the abode of gods), yashti (central mast), chhatra (umbrella/parasol – symbol of royalty and protection), pradakshina patha (circumambulatory path), vedika (railing), torana (gateway – Sanchi's four toranas, 1st century BCE). Sanchi's Great Stupa was commissioned by Ashoka (3rd century BCE) and enlarged under the Shungas and Satavahanas.

Term	Meaning
Chaitya	Prayer hall (with a stupa at the end) – Karle, Bhaja, Ajanta
Vihara	Monastery / residence for monks
Stupa	Relic mound
Torana	Ornamental gateway
Mudra	Hand gesture (e.g., Bhumisparsha – touching earth, Dharmachakra – teaching)

Stupa parts: medhi → anda → harmika → yashti → chhatra | Sanchi – Ashoka, toranas

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Parts of stupa; Buddhist sites (Sanchi, Sarnath, Bharhut, Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda); mudras.

2.8 History – Revise Next

- Reported 2026 history questions mixed ancient (founders, texts), medieval (Mughal laws and monuments) and modern (social reforms). Expect 2–3 per shift.

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Founders of dynasties; ancient texts and numbers; Mughal rulers' works; Governor-General reforms; temple–dynasty matching; stupa architecture.

CHAPTER 3

Art & Culture – Reported Questions & Explanations

3.1 Bihu – Assam

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Bihu is the main festival/folk dance of which state? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper]

✔ **ANSWER:** Assam. (verified)

Explanation. Assam celebrates three Bihus tied to the agricultural cycle: Bohag/Rongali Bihu (mid-April; Assamese New Year; sowing; dances and songs with dhol, pepa (buffalo-horn pipe), gogona), Kati/Kongali Bihu (mid-October; lean period; lamps lit in paddy fields) and Magh/Bhogali Bihu (mid-January; harvest; feasting; Meji bonfires). Bihu dance holds the Guinness record for the largest Bihu performance (2023, Guwahati, over 11,000 performers). Other Assam forms: Sattriya (classical – Shankardev), Bagurumba (Bodo 'butterfly dance'), Ojapali, Ankia Naat (one-act plays of Shankardev), Jhumur (tea tribes).

Bihu – Assam (Rongali April, Kati Oct, Bhogali Jan) | Sattriya – Assam classical | Bagurumba – Bodo

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Revise North-East festivals and dances – Hornbill (Nagaland), Chapchar Kut & Cheraw (Mizoram), Wangala (Meghalaya), Losar (Arunachal/Sikkim), Sangai & Lai Haraoba (Manipur), Hojagiri & Kharchi Puja (Tripura).

3.2 Chapchar Kut and Cheraw – Mizoram

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Chapchar Kut is celebrated in which state? [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW] and Cheraw dance belongs to which state? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper]

✔ **ANSWER:** Both are from Mizoram. (verified)

Explanation. Chapchar Kut is Mizoram's spring festival, held in March after the jhum (shifting cultivation) forest clearing is completed and the cut bamboo is left to dry. It features Cheraw (bamboo dance) and other dances such as Khuallam and Chheih Lam. Cheraw: men sit facing each other and clap long bamboo poles open and shut in rhythm, while women in colourful puan dresses dance between and across them. Other Mizo festivals: Mim Kut (after the maize harvest, honouring the dead) and Pawl Kut (after the paddy harvest; thanksgiving). 'Kut' means festival.

Chapchar Kut – Mizoram (spring, after jhum clearing) | Cheraw – bamboo dance, Mizoram | Mim Kut, Pawl Kut – Mizoram

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Festival–state pairs from the North-East appear in almost every shift.

3.3 Baul – Bengal

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** The Baul tradition is associated with which region? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper]

✔ **ANSWER:** Bengal (West Bengal and Bangladesh). (verified)

Explanation. Bauls are wandering mystic minstrels whose songs combine elements of Vaishnava bhakti and Sufism, rejecting caste and ritual and seeking the 'Moner Manush' (the person of the heart) within. Instruments: ektara (one-string), dotara, khamak, dubki. Lalon Fakir (Lalon Shah) is the most famous Baul poet. Rabindranath Tagore was influenced by Baul songs. UNESCO inscribed Baul songs on the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2008 (proclaimed 2005). Joydev Kenduli Mela (Birbhum) is a major Baul gathering.

Baul – Bengal mystic minstrels | Lalon Fakir | Ektara | UNESCO ICH (2005/2008)

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Folk music forms by state – Pandavani (Chhattisgarh – Teejan Bai), Lavani (Maharashtra), Bhatiali (Bengal boatmen), Bihugeet (Assam), Mando (Goa), Maand (Rajasthan), Kajri & Chaiti (UP–Bihar), Sohar (Bihar), Powada (Maharashtra – ballads), Naatupura Paatu (Tamil Nadu), Rabindra Sangeet & Nazrul Geeti (Bengal).

3.4 Folk Dances of Odisha

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** A question on folk dances of Odisha was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic list]

✔ **ANSWER:** Major folk dances of Odisha: Chhau (Mayurbhanj style – no masks), Ghumura, Dalkhai, Gotipua, Sambalpuri, Paika (martial), Ranappa (stilts), Karma, Danda Nata. Classical: Odissi. (verified)

Explanation. Gotipua – boys dressed as girls dance in praise of Jagannath; it is the predecessor of Odissi, along with the Mahari (devadasi) tradition. Ghumura – dance with a drum (ghumura) tied to the chest, from Kalahandi. Dalkhai – Sambalpur region, performed by women during Dussehra, sung in praise of the goddess. Chhau – three styles: Purulia (West Bengal) and Seraikela (Jharkhand) use masks; Mayurbhanj (Odisha) does not; inscribed on UNESCO's ICH list in 2010. Paika – martial dance of the Paikas (militia; Paika rebellion 1817). Odissi: tribhanga posture; dancers Kelucharan Mohapatra, Sonal Mansingh, Protima Bedi (Nrityagram).

Odisha folk – Gotipua, Ghumura, Dalkhai, Chhau (Mayurbhanj, no mask), Paika, Ranappa | Odissi – classical | Chhau UNESCO 2010

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Revise folk dances state-wise (table in GS notes Chapter 4); masks in Chhau (Purulia & Seraikela yes, Mayurbhanj no).

3.5 Classical Dances (Reported Theme)

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Classical dances were reported among the GA topics. [CGL 2026 · 30 Sep · Shift 1 · PW]

✔ **ANSWER:** Sangeet Natak Akademi recognises 8 classical dances: Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (UP), Kathakali (Kerala), Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Odissi (Odisha), Manipuri (Manipur), Sattriya (Assam). The Ministry of Culture also includes Chhau. (verified)

Explanation. Questions usually ask the state of a dance, its features or a famous exponent. Key features: Bharatanatyam – solo, fixed upper torso, Natyashastra-based, earlier 'Sadir'; Kathak –

chakkars (spins), Mughal court influence, gharanas of Lucknow, Jaipur, Banaras, Raigarh; Kathakali – dance-drama with heavy make-up (pacha = green for noble characters, kathi, thadi, kari), male performers, chenda drum; Mohiniyattam – lasya, solo female, white and gold costume; Kuchipudi – Tarangam (dancing on the rim of a brass plate with a pot of water on the head); Odissi – tribhanga, chauka; Manipuri – Ras Lila, gentle movements, no ankle bells; Sattriya – Shankardev, sattras (monasteries), Ankia Naat.

Exponent	Dance
Birju Maharaj, Sitara Devi, Shovana Narayan	Kathak
Rukmini Devi Arundale, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Padma Subrahmanyam, Alarmel Valli	Bharatanatyam
Kalamandalam Gopi, Guru Kunchu Kurup	Kathakali
Kelucharan Mohapatra, Sonal Mansingh, Sanjukta Panigrahi	Odissi
Vempati Chinna Satyam, Raja–Radha Reddy	Kuchipudi
Guru Bipin Singh, Jhaveri sisters	Manipuri
Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma, Bharati Shivaji	Mohiniyattam
Jatin Goswami, Indira P.P. Bora	Sattriya

8 classical dances (SNA) | Kerala has two – Kathakali, Mohiniyattam | Sattriya – added 2000 | Natyashastra – Bharat Muni

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Dance–state, dance–exponent, distinctive features (Tarangam, tribhanga, chakkar, pacha make-up).

3.6 Bismillah Khan – Shehnai

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Bismillah Khan is associated with which instrument? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper]

✔ **ANSWER:** Shehnai. (verified)

Explanation. Ustad Bismillah Khan (1916–2006) of Varanasi (born in Dumraon, Bihar) took the shehnai from weddings and temples to the concert stage. He played the shehnai at the Red Fort on 15 August 1947 and on the first Republic Day (1950). Bharat Ratna 2001 – the third classical musician after M.S. Subbulakshmi (1998) and Ravi Shankar (1999). The shehnai is a double-reed wind (sushira) instrument.

Bismillah Khan – shehnai, Varanasi, Bharat Ratna 2001 | Played on 15 Aug 1947 at Red Fort

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Musician–instrument pairs (see table in 3.7).

3.7 Hariprasad Chaurasia – Flute

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia is famous for which instrument? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper]

✔ **ANSWER:** Bansuri (flute). (verified)

Explanation. Hariprasad Chaurasia (born 1938, Prayagraj) is a Hindustani classical flautist, disciple of Annapurna Devi. He partnered santoor player Shivkumar Sharma as 'Shiv–Hari' for Hindi film music (Silsila, Chandni, Lamhe). Awards: Padma Bhushan (1992), Padma Vibhushan

(2000). He founded the Vrindaban Gurukul (Mumbai, Bhubaneswar). Pannalal Ghosh popularised the bansuri as a concert instrument earlier.

Musician	Instrument
Ravi Shankar, Vilayat Khan, Nikhil Banerjee, Shahid Parvez, Anoushka Shankar	Sitar
Amjad Ali Khan, Ali Akbar Khan, Buddhadev Das Gupta	Sarod
Bismillah Khan, Ali Ahmad Hussain	Shehnai
Zakir Hussain, Alla Rakha, Kishan Maharaj, Anindo Chatterjee	Tabla
Shivkumar Sharma, Bhajan Sopori, Rahul Sharma, Tarun Bhattacharya	Santoor
Hariprasad Chaurasia, Pannalal Ghosh, Ronu Majumdar	Flute (bansuri)
Ram Narayan, Sultan Khan, Sabir Khan	Sarangi
L. Subramaniam, N. Rajam, Lalgudi Jayaraman, Kunnakudi Vaidyanathan	Violin
Vishwa Mohan Bhatt	Mohan veena
U. Srinivas	Mandolin
Kadri Gopalnath	Saxophone
Palghat Mani Iyer, Umayalpuram Sivaraman	Mridangam
Vikku Vinayakram	Ghatam
Asad Ali Khan	Rudra veena
E. Gayathri, S. Balachander	Veena

Hariprasad Chaurasia – flute | Shivkumar Sharma – santoor | Amjad Ali Khan – sarod | Zakir Hussain – tabla | Ram Narayan – sarangi

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Musician–instrument matching; Bharat Ratna musicians (M.S. Subbulakshmi 1998, Ravi Shankar 1999, Lata Mangeshkar & Bismillah Khan 2001, Bhimsen Joshi 2009, Bhupen Hazarika 2019).

3.8 Culture – Revise Next

★ **REVISE NEXT:** North-East and Odisha festivals and dances; Bengal folk traditions; classical dances and exponents; musician–instrument pairs; UNESCO intangible heritage (Baul, Chhau, Kalbelia, Ramman, Kumbh, Durga Puja, Garba).

CHAPTER 4

Economy – Reported Questions & Explanations

4.1 Fiscal Deficit

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** What does fiscal deficit indicate? [CGL 2026 · 30 Sep · Prepp memory-based paper (Q46)]

✔ **ANSWER:** Fiscal deficit = total expenditure − (revenue receipts + non-debt capital receipts). It equals the total borrowing requirement of the government in a year. (verified)

Explanation. The Union Budget has revenue receipts (taxes, non-tax revenue like dividends, fees) and capital receipts (borrowings, recovery of loans, disinvestment). Non-debt capital receipts are those that do not create a liability (loan recovery, disinvestment). Whatever the government spends beyond its revenue and non-debt receipts must be borrowed – that is the fiscal deficit. It is expressed as a percentage of GDP; the FRBM Act 2003 set the path for reducing it.

Revenue deficit = revenue expenditure − revenue receipts

Fiscal deficit = total expenditure − (revenue receipts + non-debt capital receipts) = borrowings

Primary deficit = fiscal deficit − interest payments

Effective revenue deficit = revenue deficit − grants for creation of capital assets

- Primary deficit shows borrowing for current needs excluding past interest. Zero primary deficit means borrowing only to pay interest on past loans.
- Deficit financing: financing a deficit by borrowing from the RBI (printing money) – inflationary.
- Budget = Annual Financial Statement (Article 112); presented on 1 February since 2017.

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Definitions of the four deficits; FRBM Act; Article 112; capital vs revenue receipts examples.

4.2 Net Domestic Product

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** The relationship between GDP and NDP was reported (NDP = GDP − depreciation). [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic list]

✔ **ANSWER:** NDP = GDP − depreciation (consumption of fixed capital). (verified)

Explanation. Depreciation is the wear and tear of capital goods during production. Gross figures include it; net figures subtract it. 'Domestic' measures production within the country's borders; 'National' adds net factor income from abroad (NFIA).

GNP = GDP + NFIA | NDP = GDP − depreciation | NNP = GNP − depreciation | NNP at factor cost = National Income

Market price − net indirect taxes (indirect taxes − subsidies) = factor cost

- GDP measured three ways: production (value added), income, expenditure (C + I + G + (X − M)).
- In India: National Statistics Office (NSO) under MoSPI estimates GDP; base year 2011–12 (a revision to 2022–23 has been planned).
- Per capita income = national income ÷ population.

★ **REVISE NEXT:** GDP/GNP/NDP/NNP definitions; factor cost vs market price; first national income estimate (Dadabhai Naoroji); Mahalanobis National Income Committee (1949).

4.3 1991 Economic Reforms

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Questions on the 1991 economic reforms were reported in several shifts. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW; 28 Oct shift · Testbook analysis]

✔ **ANSWER:** The New Economic Policy of 1991 (LPG – Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation) was introduced by the P.V. Narasimha Rao government with Dr. Manmohan Singh as Finance Minister, in response to a balance-of-payments crisis. (verified)

Explanation. Causes: foreign exchange reserves fell to about two weeks of imports; Gulf War raised oil prices; high fiscal deficit; India pledged gold with the Bank of England and the Union Bank of Switzerland and took IMF assistance. Key measures:

- Liberalisation: industrial licensing abolished for all but a few industries (Industrial Policy, 24 July 1991); MRTP limits relaxed (MRTP Act later replaced by the Competition Act 2002); reduced reservation for the public sector.
- Privatisation: disinvestment of shares in public sector undertakings.
- Globalisation: rupee devalued (July 1991) and later made convertible on the current account (1994); import tariffs cut; FDI up to 51% allowed automatically in priority industries; FERA replaced by FEMA (1999); India joined the WTO (1995).
- Financial sector: Narasimham Committee (1991) reforms – lower CRR/SLR, entry of private banks; SEBI given statutory powers (1992).
- Tax reforms: Raja Chelliah Committee.

1991 NEP – LPG | PM P.V. Narasimha Rao, FM Manmohan Singh | Industrial Policy 24 July 1991 | Narasimham Committee 1991 | FEMA 1999 | WTO 1995

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Who launched reforms; BoP crisis; committees (Narasimham – banking, Chelliah – tax, Malhotra – insurance); FERA→FEMA; MRTP→Competition Act.

4.4 Five-Year Plans (incl. the 10th Plan)

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Objectives and targets of the Tenth Five-Year Plan, and Five-Year Plans in general, were reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW, Examshortcut; 28 Oct · Testbook]

✔ **ANSWER:** 10th Plan (2002–2007): target growth of 8% per year; aim to reduce poverty ratio by 5 percentage points by 2007; actual growth ≈ 7.6–7.8%. (verified)

Explanation. The Tenth Plan was the first to set state-wise targets and monitorable targets for social indicators (literacy, infant mortality, forest cover, access to potable water, gender gaps). Each plan's 'theme' and 'model' is a favourite question:

Plan	Years	Focus / model	Note
1st	1951–56	Agriculture, irrigation; Harrod–Domar model	Successful (target 2.1%, achieved 3.6%)
2nd	1956–61	Heavy industry; Mahalanobis model	Bhilai, Durgapur, Rourkela steel plants
3rd	1961–66	Self-reliant economy (Gadgil-Mahalanobis)	Failed – wars (1962, 1965) & drought
Plan holiday	1966–69	Three annual plans	Green Revolution started
4th	1969–74	Growth with stability; progressive self-reliance	Bank nationalisation (1969)
5th	1974–78	Garibi Hatao; poverty removal & self-reliance	Terminated a year early by Janata govt
Rolling plan	1978–80	Janata government	–
6th	1980–85	Poverty eradication; IRDP, NREP	–
7th	1985–90	Food, work, productivity; Jawahar Rozgar Yojana (1989)	–
Annual plans	1990–92	Political & BoP crisis	–
8th	1992–97	Human resource development; LPG; Rao–Manmohan model	First plan after reforms
9th	1997–2002	Growth with social justice and equality	–
10th	2002–07	8% growth; monitorable targets	–
11th	2007–12	Faster and more inclusive growth (C. Rangarajan drafted)	–
12th	2012–17	Faster, more sustainable and more inclusive growth	Last Five-Year Plan

- After 2017: NITI Aayog replaced the plans with a 15-year vision, 7-year strategy and 3-year action agenda.

1st – agriculture (Harrod-Domar) | 2nd – industry (Mahalanobis) | Plan holiday 1966–69 | 10th – 8% target | 12th – last (2012–17)

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Plan–model–focus matching; plan holiday; first plan after LPG (8th); last plan (12th); NITI Aayog (1 Jan 2015).

4.5 Economy – Revise Next

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Deficits and budget terms; national income aggregates; 1991 reforms; Five-Year Plans; RBI tools (repo, CRR, SLR); taxes (direct vs indirect; GST 2017).

CHAPTER 5

Geography & General Science – Reported Questions & Explanations

5.1 Digboi Refinery

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** A question on the Digboi oil refinery was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

✔ **ANSWER:** Digboi (Tinsukia district, Assam) – India's oldest operating oil refinery, commissioned in 1901; oil was struck there in 1889. Now run by Indian Oil Corporation (Assam Oil Division). (verified)

Explanation. Legend says oil was found when elephants of the Assam Railways and Trading Company came back with oily feet; engineers shouted 'Dig, boy, dig!' – the origin of the name, according to local lore. Digboi is called the 'Oil City of Assam' and has India's first oil museum (Centenary Museum). It is one of the oldest continuously operating refineries in the world.

Refinery / field	Fact
Digboi (Assam)	Oldest refinery (1901)
Jamnagar (Gujarat, Reliance)	World's largest refining complex at a single site
Mumbai High	Largest offshore oil field (discovered 1974)
Ankleshwar (Gujarat)	Onshore field
Barauni (Bihar), Koyali (Gujarat), Mathura (UP), Panipat (Haryana), Bongaigaon & Numaligarh (Assam), Paradip (Odisha)	Indian Oil / other PSU refineries
Kochi (Kerala)	BPCL refinery

Digboi – oldest refinery (1901, Assam) | Jamnagar – largest refining complex | Mumbai High – largest offshore field

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Mineral & energy locations – Jharia (coking coal), Neyveli (lignite), Kolar/Hutti (gold), Khetri (copper), Jaduguda (uranium), Panna (diamonds), Singrauli, Talcher; nuclear plants (Tarapur first).

5.2 Prime Meridian

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** A question on latitudinal/longitudinal markers – the Prime Meridian – was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic list]

✔ **ANSWER:** The Prime Meridian is 0° longitude, passing through the Royal Observatory at Greenwich (London); fixed at the International Meridian Conference, Washington DC, 1884. (verified)

Explanation. Longitudes (meridians) run pole to pole; 360 meridians; 1° = 4 minutes of time, 15° = 1 hour. East of Greenwich, local time is ahead; west, behind. The 180° meridian is roughly the International Date Line (crossing it westward adds a day). Latitudes (parallels) run

east–west; the Equator (0°) is the longest parallel (a great circle); Tropic of Cancer 23½°N, Tropic of Capricorn 23½°S, Arctic Circle 66½°N, Antarctic Circle 66½°S. India's Standard Meridian 82½°E passes through Mirzapur (UP), so IST = GMT + 5:30.

- Countries crossed by the Prime Meridian: UK, France, Spain, Algeria, Mali, Burkina Faso, Togo, Ghana (and Antarctica). The Equator and Prime Meridian meet in the Gulf of Guinea (Atlantic).
- Tropic of Cancer in India: 8 states – Gujarat, Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura, Mizoram.

Prime Meridian 0° – Greenwich (1884) | 1° = 4 min | 15° = 1 h | IST = GMT + 5:30 (82½°E, Mirzapur) | IDL ≈ 180°

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Time calculation from longitude; states on the Tropic of Cancer; IST meridian; countries on the Equator.

5.3 SI Unit of Flux

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** SI unit of magnetic/electric flux was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic list]

✔ **ANSWER:** Magnetic flux – weber (Wb) = tesla·m² (= volt·second). Electric flux – volt·metre (V·m), equivalently N·m²/C. (verified)

Explanation. Magnetic flux $\Phi = B \cdot A \cdot \cos\theta$ (number of magnetic field lines through an area). Magnetic field (flux density) B is measured in tesla (T = Wb/m²); CGS unit gauss (1 T = 10^4 G). Faraday's law: induced emf = $-d\Phi/dt$ (Lenz's law gives the minus sign). Electric flux $\Phi_E = E \cdot A \cdot \cos\theta$; Gauss's law: $\Phi_E = q/\varepsilon_0$. Luminous flux (light) – lumen; illuminance – lux.

Quantity	SI unit
Magnetic flux	weber (Wb)
Magnetic flux density	tesla (T)
Inductance	henry (H)
Electric flux	V·m
Electric charge	coulomb (C)
Capacitance	farad (F)
Conductance	siemens (S)
Luminous flux	lumen (lm)
Illuminance	lux (lx)
Luminous intensity	candela (cd) – SI base unit

Magnetic flux – weber | Flux density – tesla | Electric flux – V·m | Luminous flux – lumen | 1 T = 10^4 gauss

★ **REVISE NEXT:** SI units of physical quantities; named units and scientists (weber, tesla, henry, farad, siemens).

5.4 Lens Formula and Optics

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Optics – lens formula – was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic list]

✔ **ANSWER:** Lens formula: 1/f = 1/v − 1/u (Cartesian sign convention). Magnification m = v/u = h'/h. Power P = 1/f (f in metres), unit dioptre. (verified)

Explanation. Mirror formula is 1/f = 1/v + 1/u (note the plus sign). For a convex lens f is positive (converging); concave lens f is negative (diverging). Power of combination of thin lenses in contact: P = P_1 + P_2. Example: a convex lens of focal length 50 cm has power +2 D; a concave lens of 25 cm has −4 D.

Situation	Lens/mirror
Myopia	Concave lens
Hypermetropia	Convex lens
Presbyopia	Bifocal
Astigmatism	Cylindrical lens
Rear-view mirror	Convex mirror
Shaving mirror, dentist	Concave mirror
Magnifying glass	Convex lens

Lens 1/f = 1/v − 1/u | Mirror 1/f = 1/v + 1/u | P = 1/f (dioptre) | Convex +, concave −

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Lens power calculations; eye defects and correction; uses of mirrors; refraction phenomena (twinkling, mirage, TIR in optical fibre).

5.5 GSLV

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Satellite launch vehicles – GSLV – were reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic list]

✔ **ANSWER:** GSLV – Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle (ISRO); a three-stage rocket whose third stage is a cryogenic upper stage (liquid hydrogen + liquid oxygen); used to place heavier satellites in geosynchronous transfer orbit. (verified)

Explanation. ISRO's vehicles: SLV-3 (first, 1980, Rohini), ASLV, PSLV (polar/sun-synchronous orbits; four stages alternating solid–liquid; 'workhorse'; record 104 satellites in 2017; Chandrayaan-1, Mangalyaan, Aditya-L1), GSLV Mk II (indigenous cryogenic stage from 2014), LVM3/GSLV Mk III (heaviest; Chandrayaan-2 & 3; OneWeb; human-rated for Gaganyaan), SSLV (small satellites). Launch site: Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota (Andhra Pradesh). Cryogenic engine technology was denied to India under the 1990s MTCR pressure, which led to the indigenous Cryogenic Upper Stage project.

GSLV – cryogenic 3rd stage, GTO | PSLV – polar/SSO | LVM3 – heaviest (Chandrayaan-2/3) | Sriharikota – launch site

★ **REVISE NEXT:** ISRO vehicle–mission pairs; full forms PSLV/GSLV; Chandrayaan-3 landing (23 Aug 2023, south pole); Aditya-L1 at L1.

5.6 General Science – Revise Next

- Shift analyses report 5–7 General Science questions per shift in 2026 – the single largest block in GA. Physics units and optics, chemistry (compounds, acids, metals) and biology (vitamins, diseases, cells, human body) all appear.

★ **REVISE NEXT:** SI units; optics formulas; electricity basics; common chemical names; vitamins and deficiency diseases; human body facts; disease–pathogen pairs.

CHAPTER 6

Static GK – Books, Sports, Awards: Reported Questions & Explanations

6.1 'Tomb of Sand' – International Booker Prize 2022

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Who won the 2022 International Booker Prize for 'Tomb of Sand'? [CGL 2026 · 30 Sep · Prepp memory-based paper (Q42)]

✔ **ANSWER:** Geetanjali Shree (Hindi novel 'Ret Samadhi'), translated into English by Daisy Rockwell. (verified)

Explanation. It was the first book translated from any Indian language to win the International Booker Prize; the £50,000 prize is shared equally between author and translator. The novel follows an 80-year-old widow who travels to Pakistan to confront her unresolved past from Partition. The International Booker is for fiction translated into English and published in the UK/Ireland; the Booker Prize (since 1969) is for fiction originally written in English. In 2025 Banu Mushtaq won the International Booker for 'Heart Lamp' (Kannada; translated by Deepa Bhasthi) – the first Kannada work to win.

Indian / Indian-origin Booker winner	Book	Year
V.S. Naipaul	In a Free State	1971
Salman Rushdie	Midnight's Children	1981 (also 'Booker of Bookers' 1993, 'Best of the Booker' 2008)
Arundhati Roy	The God of Small Things	1997 (first Indian citizen)
Kiran Desai	The Inheritance of Loss	2006
Aravind Adiga	The White Tiger	2008
Geetanjali Shree (Intl.)	Tomb of Sand	2022
Banu Mushtaq (Intl.)	Heart Lamp	2025

Tomb of Sand (Ret Samadhi) – Geetanjali Shree, tr. Daisy Rockwell – International Booker 2022 | Heart Lamp – Banu Mushtaq – 2025

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Booker winners of Indian origin; difference between Booker and International Booker; other literary awards (Jnanpith, Sahitya Akademi).

6.2 Booker Prize (Reported Theme)

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** A question on the Booker Prize was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

✔ **ANSWER:** The Booker Prize is a British literary award (since 1969) for the best novel written in English and published in the UK or Ireland; prize money £50,000. (verified)

Explanation. Originally sponsored by Booker McConnell; called the 'Man Booker Prize' 2002–2019 under the Man Group; renamed the Booker Prize in 2019. Since 2014 authors of any nationality writing in English are eligible (earlier limited to the Commonwealth, Ireland and Zimbabwe). Recent winners are current affairs – check the latest year separately.

Booker – since 1969, English novels, £50,000 | Man Booker 2002–2019 | International Booker – translated fiction

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Booker vs International Booker; Indian winners; Nobel in Literature (Tagore 1913).

6.3 'A Suitable Boy'

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Who wrote 'A Suitable Boy'? [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper – reported, not confirmed by other sources]

✔ **ANSWER:** Vikram Seth (1993). (verified)

Explanation. One of the longest English-language novels published in one volume (~1,350 pages), set in newly independent India (1951–52) around Mrs Rupa Mehra's search for a husband for her daughter Lata. Vikram Seth's other works: The Golden Gate (novel in verse), An Equal Music, From Heaven Lake (travel), Two Lives. He received the Sahitya Akademi Award (1988, The Golden Gate) and Padma Shri (2007).

A Suitable Boy – Vikram Seth (1993)

★ **REVISE NEXT:** English novels by Indian authors (see 6.4 table).

6.4 'Train to Pakistan'

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Who wrote 'Train to Pakistan'? [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

✔ **ANSWER:** Khushwant Singh (1956). (verified)

Explanation. The novel is set in the fictional border village of Mano Majra during the Partition of 1947 and shows communal violence through the story of Juggut Singh and Nooran. Khushwant Singh (1915–2014) was a journalist (editor of The Illustrated Weekly of India, Hindustan Times), historian ('A History of the Sikhs') and author of 'Delhi', 'The Company of Women', 'Truth, Love and a Little Malice' (autobiography). Padma Bhushan (1974; returned in 1984 after Operation Blue Star), Padma Vibhushan (2007).

Book (Partition/Indian English classics)	Author
Train to Pakistan	Khushwant Singh
Tamas	Bhisham Sahni (Hindi)
Pinjar	Amrita Pritam (Punjabi)
Ice-Candy-Man	Bapsi Sidhwa
Midnight's Children	Salman Rushdie
A Suitable Boy	Vikram Seth
Malgudi Days, The Guide	R.K. Narayan
Untouchable, Coolie	Mulk Raj Anand
Kanthapura	Raja Rao

Book (Partition/Indian English classics)	Author
The God of Small Things	Arundhati Roy
The White Tiger	Aravind Adiga
The Shadow Lines	Amitav Ghosh

Train to Pakistan – Khushwant Singh | Tamas – Bhisham Sahni | Pinjar – Amrita Pritam | Kanthapura – Raja Rao

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Book–author pairs remain one of the most frequent static GK question types.

6.5 'Malgudi Days'

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Who wrote 'Malgudi Days'? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper]

✔ **ANSWER:** R.K. Narayan (Rasipuram Krishnaswami Iyer Narayanaswami). (verified)

Explanation. Malgudi is a fictional South Indian town that appears in most of Narayan's works. Malgudi Days (1943) is a collection of short stories; the TV series (1986) was directed by Shankar Nag with sketches by R.K. Laxman (Narayan's younger brother, creator of 'The Common Man'). Other works: Swami and Friends (first novel, 1935), The Guide (Sahitya Akademi Award 1960; film 'Guide' 1965), The English Teacher, The Financial Expert, The Man-Eater of Malgudi. Padma Vibhushan (2000); nominated to the Rajya Sabha (1985).

Malgudi Days – R.K. Narayan | The Guide – Sahitya Akademi 1960 | R.K. Laxman – brother, 'Common Man'

★ **REVISE NEXT:** R.K. Narayan's works; Sahitya Akademi winners in English.

6.6 First Indian Grand Slam Winner

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Who was the first Indian to win a Grand Slam title? [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

✔ **ANSWER:** Mahesh Bhupathi – 1997 French Open mixed doubles, with Rika Hiraki (Japan). (verified as reported by the source)

Explanation. Bhupathi later completed a career Grand Slam in mixed doubles. With Leander Paes he won the 1999 French Open and Wimbledon men's doubles. Leander Paes – Olympic bronze 1996 (Atlanta), 18 Grand Slam doubles/mixed titles. Sania Mirza – 6 Grand Slam doubles/mixed titles; first Indian woman to win a WTA title (Hyderabad Open 2005). Rohan Bopanna – 2024 Australian Open men's doubles (with Matthew Ebden), oldest man to become world No. 1 in doubles (aged 43). Ramanathan Krishnan and Vijay Amritraj reached Wimbledon singles quarter/semi-finals. Grand Slams: Australian Open (hard, January), French Open/Roland Garros (clay, May–June), Wimbledon (grass, oldest – 1877), US Open (hard, Aug–Sept).

First Indian Grand Slam – Mahesh Bhupathi, 1997 French Open mixed doubles | Wimbledon – grass, oldest (1877) | French Open – clay

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Indian tennis firsts; Grand Slam surfaces; Davis Cup (men) and Billie Jean King Cup (women).

6.7 Marathon Distance

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** What is the official length of a marathon? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper; answer given as option (a) 42.195 km]

✔ **ANSWER:** 42.195 km (26 miles 385 yards). (verified)

Explanation. The race commemorates the legend of Pheidippides running from Marathon to Athens (490 BCE) to announce the Greek victory over the Persians. The distance was fixed at 42.195 km from the 1908 London Olympics (start at Windsor Castle, finish before the royal box) and standardised by the IAAF in 1921. Half marathon = 21.0975 km. Ultra-marathon = any distance above 42.195 km.

Sport measurement	Value
Marathon	42.195 km
Cricket pitch	22 yards (20.12 m)
Football field (FIFA)	100–110 m × 64–75 m (international)
Hockey field	91.4 m × 55 m
Badminton court	13.4 m × 6.1 m (doubles)
Tennis court	23.77 m × 10.97 m (doubles)
Olympic swimming pool	50 m
Basketball hoop height	10 ft (3.05 m)
Javelin (men)	800 g
Shot put (men)	7.26 kg

Marathon 42.195 km (1908 London) | Half marathon 21.0975 km | Cricket pitch 22 yards

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Sports measurements; number of players per team; Olympic history (Athens 1896).

6.8 LBW – Cricket Term

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** LBW is associated with which sport? [CGL 2026 · 5 Oct · Prepp memory-based paper]

✔ **ANSWER:** Cricket – Leg Before Wicket. (verified)

Explanation. A batter is out LBW if the ball would have hit the stumps but is intercepted by the batter's body (usually the pad), subject to conditions: the ball must not pitch outside leg stump, and if the batter offers a shot, the impact must be in line with the stumps. Decisions can be reviewed through DRS (Decision Review System) using ball-tracking (Hawk-Eye). Cricket laws are maintained by the MCC (Marylebone Cricket Club, Lord's). Modes of dismissal: bowled, caught, LBW, run out, stumped, hit wicket, obstructing the field (includes handling the ball since 2017), hit the ball twice, timed out, and retired out.

Term	Sport
LBW, googly, doosra, yorker, maiden over, silly point	Cricket
Bully, penalty corner, push-in	Hockey
Deuce, ace, love, let	Tennis
Birdie, bogey, eagle, caddie	Golf
Checkmate, castling, gambit	Chess

Term	Sport
Chukker, mallet	Polo
Smash, drop, shuttlecock	Badminton
Raid, lona, cant	Kabaddi

LBW – Leg Before Wicket (cricket) | Laws of cricket – MCC | DRS uses Hawk-Eye

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Sports terms; sports full forms; trophies (Ranji – cricket, Durand – football, Thomas/Uber – badminton).

6.9 2022 FIFA World Cup Host

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** Which country hosted the 2022 FIFA World Cup? [CGL 2026 · 30 Sep · Prepp memory-based paper (Q45)]

✔ **ANSWER:** Qatar – the first World Cup held in the Arab world and the first in November–December. Argentina won (beat France on penalties; Lionel Messi – Golden Ball; Kylian Mbappé – Golden Boot). (verified)

Explanation. Mascot La'eeb; final at Lusail Stadium. 2026 World Cup: hosted jointly by the USA, Canada and Mexico with 48 teams for the first time. The first World Cup was in 1930 in Uruguay (Uruguay won). Brazil has won the most titles (5). FIFA HQ: Zurich. India's women's U-17 World Cup was hosted in 2022.

FIFA WC 2022 – Qatar, Argentina won | 2026 – USA/Canada/Mexico, 48 teams | First WC 1930 – Uruguay | Most titles – Brazil (5)

★ **REVISE NEXT:** World Cup hosts and winners; FIFA HQ; India's ODI and T20 World Cup wins.

6.10 Manu Bhaker

▶ **REPORTED QUESTION:** A question on Manu Bhaker was reported. [CGL 2026 · 1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

✔ **ANSWER:** Manu Bhaker (shooter, Haryana) became the first Indian athlete since independence to win two medals at a single Olympics – bronze in women's 10 m air pistol and bronze in 10 m air pistol mixed team (with Sarabjot Singh), Paris 2024. (verified)

Explanation. She also won the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna (announced January 2025). Her bronze in 10 m air pistol was India's first medal at Paris 2024 and India's first Olympic shooting medal by a woman. India's Paris 2024 tally: 6 medals – 1 silver (Neeraj Chopra, javelin) and 5 bronze (Manu Bhaker – 10 m air pistol; Manu Bhaker & Sarabjot Singh – mixed team; Swapnil Kusale – 50 m rifle 3 positions; men's hockey team; Aman Sehrawat – wrestling 57 kg).

Manu Bhaker – 2 bronze, Paris 2024 (10 m air pistol; mixed team with Sarabjot Singh) | First Indian with 2 medals in one Games post-independence

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Indian Olympic medallists (Bindra 2008 first individual gold; Neeraj Chopra gold 2021; Karnam Malleswari first woman medallist 2000).

6.11 Static GK – Revise Next

★ **REVISE NEXT:** Book–author pairs; Booker and International Booker; sports firsts, terms and measurements; FIFA and cricket World Cups; Olympic medallists; musicians and instruments.

CHAPTER 7

Excluded Current Affairs & Shift Coverage

7.1 Current-Affairs Items Reported (Not Explained Here)

As requested, current affairs are left out of the explanations. These items were reported from 2026 shifts; read them from a monthly current-affairs source.

Reported item	Shift (source)
IMEC (India–Middle East–Europe Economic Corridor)	1 Oct, Shift 1 (Examshortcut)
Appointment of the Chief of Naval Staff	1 Oct, Shift 1 (PW topic list)
Bank behind 'Project WAVE'	1 Oct (Prepp memory-based paper, unconfirmed)
Venue of the 2025 ASEAN Summit	1 Oct (Prepp memory-based paper, unconfirmed)
BRICS, NATO, G7, G20, SCO-related questions	30 Sep, Shift 1 (PW)
Summits, appointments, indices, brand ambassadors (Jan–Aug 2026)	Recommended revision area across shifts (PW)

✔ **TOPPER TRICK:** Coaching analyses put current affairs at only 3–5 of the 25 GA questions per 2026 shift. Static GS (20+ questions) decides your GA score.

7.2 Shift-by-Shift Coverage in This Book

Date & shift	What was available	Reported GA difficulty (sources)
30 Sep – Shift 1	Topics + 3 questions (Prepp PDF, PW)	Moderate; 19–20 good attempts
30 Sep – Shift 2	Not published at compilation time	–
30 Sep – Shift 3	Topic counts only (Prepp)	Moderate
1 Oct – Shift 1	Most detailed: ~25 items (Examshortcut, PW)	Moderate; 15–20 good attempts
1 Oct – Shift 2	Topic list only (Prepp, Notifyhere)	Moderate; 15–18
1 Oct – Shift 3	Topic counts only (Prepp)	Easy–Moderate; 14–17
1 Oct (shift unstated)	4 items from Prepp memory-based PDF	–
3 Oct – Shift 1	Topic counts only (Prepp)	Moderate; 19–20
3 Oct – Shifts 2, 3	'To be updated' on sources	–
5 Oct (shift unstated)	~12 items from Prepp memory-based PDF	–
8 Oct	Difficulty only (Career Power, Adda247)	Moderate; 19–20
9 Oct – Shift 3	Difficulty only (Examshortcut)	Difficult
22 Oct – Shift 3	Difficulty only (Examshortcut)	Easy

Date & shift	What was available	Reported GA difficulty (sources)
28 Oct	Topics: Five-Year Plans, Articles, 1991 reforms (Testbook)	Moderate; ~15 doable
Other shifts (to end Oct)	Memory-based PDFs exist on Career Power, Adda247, Testbook, Prepp but could not be opened from this environment	–

✖ **COMMON MISTAKE:** This book covers only a fraction of the roughly 75+ CGL 2026 Tier-1 shifts. When the full shift-wise papers can be read (network access or uploaded PDFs), every remaining static-GS question can be added chapter-wise in the same format.

7.3 Pattern Lessons From 2026 (Useful for JE, CPO, CHSL 2026)

- Constitutional Articles came in clusters (one shift had about five questions on Articles 243 and 131A). Learn Articles group-wise, including omitted ones (131A, 144A, 226A).
- The economy section repeated 1991 reforms and Five-Year Plans across different dates (1 Oct and 28 Oct).
- Culture questions favoured the North-East (Mizoram, Assam) and the East (Odisha, Bengal).
- Books and authors, musicians and instruments, and sports firsts/terms formed most of 'static GK'.
- General Science was the largest single block (5–7 questions), so do not skip it for current affairs.

CHAPTER 8

Sources

8.1 Sources Used for the Reported Questions

All items are candidate-recalled (memory-based) questions or topic lists published by these sites. They were consulted through web-search summaries on 30 October 2026. None is an official SSC document.

Source	Page
Prepp – SSC CGL Tier 1 Question Paper 2026 (date-wise PDFs)	prepp.in/ssc-cgl-exam/question-paper-2026
Prepp – Memory Based Paper 30 Sep 2026	cdn-images.prepp.in (SSC_CGL_Tier_1_Memory_Based_Paper_Sep_30_2026)
Prepp – Memory Based Paper 1 Oct 2026	cdn-images.prepp.in (SSC_CGL_Tier_1_2026_Memory_Based_Paper_PDF_Oct_01_2026)
Prepp – Memory Based Paper 5 Oct 2026	cdn-images.prepp.in (SSC_CGL_Tier_1_2026_Memory_Based_Paper_PDF_Oct_05_2026)
Prepp – Exam analyses (30 Sep S1, S3; 1 Oct S1–S3; 3 Oct S1, S3)	prepp.in/news/e-514-ssc-cgl-tier-1-exam-analysis-2026-...
Examshortcut – CGL 2026 Tier 1 analysis; 1 Oct Shift 1	examshortcut.in/exam-analysis/ssc-cgl-2026/
Physics Wallah – CGL 2026 reviews (30 Sep S1; 1 Oct)	pw.live/ssc/exams/ssc-cgl-exam-review-2026-...
Career Power – CGL Question Paper 2026; Exam Analysis 2026	careerpower.in/blog/ssc-cgl-tier-1-question-paper-2026; .../ssc-cgl-exam-analysis-2026
Adda247 – CGL Question Paper 2026; Exam Analysis 2026	adda247.com/exams/ssc/ssc-cgl-question-paper-2026/; .../ssc-cgl-exam-analysis-2026/
Testbook – CGL Question Paper 2026; Exam Analysis 2026 (28 Oct)	testbook.com/news/ssc-cgl-exam-question-paper-2026-out/; .../ssc-cgl-exam-analysis-2026/
Notifyhere – CGL 30 Sep, 1 Oct, 3 Oct analyses	notifyhere.com/ssc-cgl-...
Testbook / Xylem / Adda247 – SSC Calendar 2026-27	testbook.com/news/ssc-new-exam-calendar-2026-27-out/

8.2 What Is Original in This Book

- All explanations, tables, 'revise next' lists, key-fact strips and pattern analysis are written for this book and are not copied from the sources.
- Answers were checked against standard facts. Where a source's answer pairing was unclear (stupa umbrella) or an item appeared in only one source (Kailasanatha temple, A Suitable Boy), this is stated next to the question.

✖ **COMMON MISTAKE:** Verify everything against the official SSC answer key for CGL 2026 Tier-1 when it is published on ssc.gov.in.

APPENDIX

Appendix A – One-Place Answer Sheet

Every yellow strip (answers and key facts) from the chapters, collected chapter by chapter.

Polity – Reported Questions & Explanations

Art 1 – Union of States (no right to secede) | Art 2 – admit/establish new states (from outside India) | Art 3 – form new states, alter areas/boundaries/names (simple majority; President's recommendation) | Art 4 – Art 2 & 3 laws are not Art 368 amendments

Art 32 – SC writs ('heart and soul') | Art 226 – HC writs (wider scope) | Art 359 – suspension in emergency (not Art 20, 21)

Art 131 – SC original jurisdiction (Centre–state disputes) | Art 131A – inserted 42nd (1976), omitted 43rd (1977) | Art 143 – advisory jurisdiction | Art 141 – SC law binding on all courts

73rd (1992) – Part IX, Art 243–243-O, 11th Schedule (29) | 74th – Part IX-A, 12th Schedule (18) | Women ≥ 1/3 | Term 5 years | First PRI – Nagaur 1959

97th (2011) – Art 19(1)(c) co-operatives, Art 43B, Part IX-B | Part IX-B partly struck down 2021 (Rajendra Shah case)

Art 312 – new AIS by RS 2/3 resolution | Art 249 – RS resolution for State List | Existing AIS – IAS, IPS, IFoS (1966) | Patel – father of AIS

Art 352 national (used 3 times) | Art 356 President's Rule | Art 360 financial (never used) | Art 163 Governor's discretion | Art 200 reserve bill

1 July 2024 – BNS (IPC), BNSS (CrPC), BSA (Evidence Act) | Zero FIR – BNSS Sec 173 | Sedition removed; Sec 152 BNS

History – Reported Questions & Explanations

Chandragupta Maurya – founder (321 BCE) | Chanakya – Arthashastra | Megasthenes – Indica | Seleucus defeated 305 BCE | Died at Shravanabelagola

18 Mahapuranas | Matsya Purana oldest | Pancha Lakshana – 5 topics | Mahabharata – 18 parvas, 1 lakh verses | Ramayana – 7 kandas, 24,000 verses

Fatawa-e-Alamgiri – Aurangzeb (c. 1664–72), Hanafi law | Jizya re-imposed 1679 | Dara Shikoh – Majma-ul-Bahrain

Taj Mahal – Shah Jahan, for Mumtaz Mahal | 1632–1653 | Ustad Ahmad Lahori | Makrana marble | UNESCO 1983

Sati abolished – Regulation XVII, 4 Dec 1829, Bentinck + Ram Mohan Roy | Widow Remarriage – 1856 | Sarda Act – 1929

Kailasanatha, Kanchipuram – Pallava (Narasimhavarman II) | Kailasa, Ellora – Rashtrakuta (Krishna I) | Shore Temple – Pallava | Konark – Eastern Ganga

Stupa parts: medhi → anda → harmika → yashti → chhatra | Sanchi – Ashoka, toranas

Art & Culture – Reported Questions & Explanations

Bihu – Assam (Rongali April, Kati Oct, Bhogali Jan) | Sattriya – Assam classical | Bagurumba – Bodo

Chapchar Kut – Mizoram (spring, after jhum clearing) | Cheraw – bamboo dance, Mizoram | Mim Kut, Pawl Kut – Mizoram

Baul – Bengal mystic minstrels | Lalon Fakir | Ektara | UNESCO ICH (2005/2008)

Odisha folk – Gotipua, Ghumura, Dalkhai, Chhau (Mayurbhanj, no mask), Paika, Ranappa | Odissi – classical | Chhau UNESCO 2010

8 classical dances (SNA) | Kerala has two – Kathakali, Mohiniyattam | Sattriya – added 2000 | Natyashastra – Bharat Muni

Bismillah Khan – shehnai, Varanasi, Bharat Ratna 2001 | Played on 15 Aug 1947 at Red Fort

Hariprasad Chaurasia – flute | Shivkumar Sharma – santoor | Amjad Ali Khan – sarod | Zakir Hussain – tabla | Ram Narayan – sarangi

Economy – Reported Questions & Explanations

Revenue deficit = revenue expenditure − revenue receipts

Fiscal deficit = total expenditure − (revenue receipts + non-debt capital receipts) = borrowings

Primary deficit = fiscal deficit − interest payments

Effective revenue deficit = revenue deficit − grants for creation of capital assets

GNP = GDP + NFIA | NDP = GDP − depreciation | NNP = GNP − depreciation | NNP at factor cost = National Income

Market price − net indirect taxes (indirect taxes − subsidies) = factor cost

1991 NEP – LPG | PM P.V. Narasimha Rao, FM Manmohan Singh | Industrial Policy 24 July 1991 | Narasimham Committee 1991 | FEMA 1999 | WTO 1995

1st – agriculture (Harrod-Domar) | 2nd – industry (Mahalanobis) | Plan holiday 1966–69 | 10th – 8% target | 12th – last (2012–17)

Geography & General Science – Reported Questions & Explanations

Digboi – oldest refinery (1901, Assam) | Jamnagar – largest refining complex | Mumbai High – largest offshore field

Prime Meridian 0° – Greenwich (1884) | 1° = 4 min | 15° = 1 h | IST = GMT + 5:30 (82½°E, Mirzapur) | IDL ≈ 180°

Magnetic flux – weber | Flux density – tesla | Electric flux – V·m | Luminous flux – lumen | 1 T = 10^4 gauss

Lens 1/f = 1/v − 1/u | Mirror 1/f = 1/v + 1/u | P = 1/f (dioptre) | Convex +, concave −

GSLV – cryogenic 3rd stage, GTO | PSLV – polar/SSO | LVM3 – heaviest (Chandrayaan-2/3) | Sriharikota – launch site

Static GK – Books, Sports, Awards: Reported Questions & Explanations

Tomb of Sand (Ret Samadhi) – Geetanjali Shree, tr. Daisy Rockwell – International Booker 2022 | Heart Lamp – Banu Mushtaq – 2025

Booker – since 1969, English novels, £50,000 | Man Booker 2002–2019 | International Booker – translated fiction

A Suitable Boy – Vikram Seth (1993)

Train to Pakistan – Khushwant Singh | Tamas – Bhisham Sahni | Pinjar – Amrita Pritam | Kanthapura – Raja Rao

Malgudi Days – R.K. Narayan | The Guide – Sahitya Akademi 1960 | R.K. Laxman – brother, 'Common Man'

First Indian Grand Slam – Mahesh Bhupathi, 1997 French Open mixed doubles | Wimbledon – grass, oldest (1877) | French Open – clay

Marathon 42.195 km (1908 London) | Half marathon 21.0975 km | Cricket pitch 22 yards

LBW – Leg Before Wicket (cricket) | Laws of cricket – MCC | DRS uses Hawk-Eye

FIFA WC 2022 – Qatar, Argentina won | 2026 – USA/Canada/Mexico, 48 teams | First WC 1930 – Uruguay | Most titles – Brazil (5)

Manu Bhaker – 2 bronze, Paris 2024 (10 m air pistol; mixed team with Sarabjot Singh) | First Indian with 2 medals in one Games post-independence

APPENDIX

Appendix B – What to Revise Next

All "revise next" boxes in one place, chapter-wise.

Polity – Reported Questions & Explanations

★ Article 1 wording; difference between Article 2 and Article 3; First Schedule lists states and UTs; Ambedkar's reason for 'Union'.

★ Revise Articles 12–35 group-wise; writ meanings; difference between Art 32 and Art 226; 'heart and soul' quote.

★ SC jurisdictions – original (131), writ (32), appellate (132–134), advisory (143), court of record (129), review (137), complete justice (142). What the 42nd, 43rd and 44th Amendments did.

★ Article number for Gram Sabha (243A), State Election Commission (243K), State Finance Commission (243I); number of Eleventh-Schedule subjects; Balwant Rai Mehta; Article 40.

★ Revise the important amendments table – 1st, 7th, 24th, 42nd, 44th, 52nd, 61st, 73rd, 74th, 86th, 91st, 97th, 101st, 103rd, 104th, 106th.

★ Special powers of Rajya Sabha (249, 312); exclusive powers of Lok Sabha (money bill, no-confidence motion); UPSC (Art 315–323).

★ Emergency Articles and their approval periods; grounds of national emergency (44th Amendment replaced 'internal disturbance' with 'armed rebellion'); Governor's discretionary powers; Sarkaria and Punchhi Commissions on Centre–state relations.

★ Which law replaced which; date of enforcement; zero FIR and e-FIR; community service; offences newly defined.

★ Articles with numbers, amendments with years, Supreme Court jurisdiction, emergency provisions, Panchayati Raj, new criminal laws (BNS/BNSS/BSA).

History – Reported Questions & Explanations

★ Revise founders of dynasties: Haryanka – Bimbisara, Nanda – Mahapadma Nanda, Shunga – Pushyamitra, Kanva – Vasudeva, Satavahana – Simuka, Gupta – Sri Gupta (Chandragupta I real founder), Pushyabhuti – Pushyabhuti (Harsha), Pallava – Simhavishnu, Chalukya (Badami) – Pulakeshin I, Rashtrakuta – Dantidurga, Pala – Gopala, Chola (imperial) – Vijayalaya, Slave dynasty – Qutbuddin Aibak, Vijayanagara – Harihara & Bukka, Bahmani – Hasan Gangu, Mughal – Babur.

★ Number-based questions on ancient texts; Upanishad source of 'Satyameva Jayate' (Mundaka); Samaveda and music; Gita's 18 chapters.

★ Mughal books and authors; Aurangzeb's policies; Dara Shikoh's translations; Bibi ka Maqbara.

★ Mughal monuments and builders – Humayun's Tomb (Hamida Banu Begum; first garden tomb), Buland Darwaza and Fatehpur Sikri (Akbar), Itmad-ud-Daulah's tomb (Nur Jahan; first use of pietra dura), Akbar's tomb at Sikandra (Jahangir), Red Fort & Jama Masjid (Shah Jahan), Bibi ka Maqbara (Azam Shah).

★ Social reform laws with Governors-General; Brahmo Samaj (1828); Vidyasagar; Sarda Act age limits (girls 14, boys 18 originally).

★ Temple–dynasty pairs; Nagara/Dravida/Vesara styles; UNESCO temples (Great Living Chola Temples, Hoysala temples 2023, Ramappa 2021).

★ Parts of stupa; Buddhist sites (Sanchi, Sarnath, Bharhut, Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda); mudras.

★ Founders of dynasties; ancient texts and numbers; Mughal rulers' works; Governor-General reforms; temple–dynasty matching; stupa architecture.

Art & Culture – Reported Questions & Explanations

★ Revise North-East festivals and dances – Hornbill (Nagaland), Chapchar Kut & Cheraw (Mizoram), Wangala (Meghalaya), Losar (Arunachal/Sikkim), Sangai & Lai Haraoba (Manipur), Hojagiri & Kharchi Puja (Tripura).

★ Festival–state pairs from the North-East appear in almost every shift.

★ Folk music forms by state – Pandavani (Chhattisgarh – Teejan Bai), Lavani (Maharashtra), Bhatiali (Bengal boatmen), Bihugeet (Assam), Mando (Goa), Maand (Rajasthan), Kajri & Chaiti (UP–Bihar), Sohar (Bihar), Powada (Maharashtra – ballads), Naatupura Paatu (Tamil Nadu), Rabindra Sangeet & Nazrul Geeti (Bengal).

★ Revise folk dances state-wise (table in GS notes Chapter 4); masks in Chhau (Purulia & Seraikela yes, Mayurbhanj no).

★ Dance–state, dance–exponent, distinctive features (Tarangam, tribhanga, chakkar, pacha make-up).

★ Musician–instrument pairs (see table in 3.7).

★ Musician–instrument matching; Bharat Ratna musicians (M.S. Subbulakshmi 1998, Ravi Shankar 1999, Lata Mangeshkar & Bismillah Khan 2001, Bhimsen Joshi 2009, Bhupen Hazarika 2019).

★ North-East and Odisha festivals and dances; Bengal folk traditions; classical dances and exponents; musician–instrument pairs; UNESCO intangible heritage (Baul, Chhau, Kalbelia, Ramman, Kumbh, Durga Puja, Garba).

Economy – Reported Questions & Explanations

★ Definitions of the four deficits; FRBM Act; Article 112; capital vs revenue receipts examples.

★ GDP/GNP/NDP/NNP definitions; factor cost vs market price; first national income estimate (Dadabhai Naoroji); Mahalanobis National Income Committee (1949).

★ Who launched reforms; BoP crisis; committees (Narasimham – banking, Chelliah – tax, Malhotra – insurance); FERA→FEMA; MRTP→Competition Act.

★ Plan–model–focus matching; plan holiday; first plan after LPG (8th); last plan (12th); NITI Aayog (1 Jan 2015).

★ Deficits and budget terms; national income aggregates; 1991 reforms; Five-Year Plans; RBI tools (repo, CRR, SLR); taxes (direct vs indirect; GST 2017).

Geography & General Science – Reported Questions & Explanations

★ Mineral & energy locations – Jharia (coking coal), Neyveli (lignite), Kolar/Hutti (gold), Khetri (copper), Jaduguda (uranium), Panna (diamonds), Singrauli, Talcher; nuclear plants (Tarapur first).

★ Time calculation from longitude; states on the Tropic of Cancer; IST meridian; countries on the Equator.

- ★ SI units of physical quantities; named units and scientists (weber, tesla, henry, farad, siemens).
- ★ Lens power calculations; eye defects and correction; uses of mirrors; refraction phenomena (twinkling, mirage, TIR in optical fibre).
- ★ ISRO vehicle–mission pairs; full forms PSLV/GSLV; Chandrayaan-3 landing (23 Aug 2023, south pole); Aditya-L1 at L1.
- ★ SI units; optics formulas; electricity basics; common chemical names; vitamins and deficiency diseases; human body facts; disease–pathogen pairs.

Static GK – Books, Sports, Awards: Reported Questions & Explanations

- ★ Booker winners of Indian origin; difference between Booker and International Booker; other literary awards (Jnanpith, Sahitya Akademi).
- ★ Booker vs International Booker; Indian winners; Nobel in Literature (Tagore 1913).
- ★ English novels by Indian authors (see 6.4 table).
- ★ Book–author pairs remain one of the most frequent static GK question types.
- ★ R.K. Narayan's works; Sahitya Akademi winners in English.
- ★ Indian tennis firsts; Grand Slam surfaces; Davis Cup (men) and Billie Jean King Cup (women).
- ★ Sports measurements; number of players per team; Olympic history (Athens 1896).
- ★ Sports terms; sports full forms; trophies (Ranji – cricket, Durand – football, Thomas/Uber – badminton).
- ★ World Cup hosts and winners; FIFA HQ; India's ODI and T20 World Cup wins.
- ★ Indian Olympic medallists (Bindra 2008 first individual gold; Neeraj Chopra gold 2021; Karnam Malleswari first woman medallist 2000).
- ★ Book–author pairs; Booker and International Booker; sports firsts, terms and measurements; FIFA and cricket World Cups; Olympic medallists; musicians and instruments.